

OnePlus Nord CE4

‘Nothing’ rivals this in performance

This year, the OnePlus Nord CE4 is the first smartphone to arrive in the “Nord 4” series for 2024. Now, there are improvements across the board as compared to the OnePlus Nord CE 3 5G from last year, but there are also downgrades. For example, this year we are getting only two cameras as compared to the triple camera setup on the OnePlus Nord CE 3 5G. Further, there is only an 8GB RAM variant, while the OnePlus Nord CE 3 5G had launched with a 12GB RAM variant last year. But has the overall experience improved? Let’s find out!

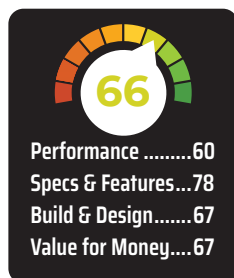
DESIGN

Starting with the design, the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G is a good looking smartphone. Firstly, what everyone is talking about, the marble-like finish on the back panel. This is something OnePlus is pushing for quite a bit, we have now seen three smartphones with marble-like finish from the OnePlus lineup.

To the touch it may not feel as premium as the OnePlus 11 Marble Odyssey edition or the OnePlus 12, but it looks absolutely sick! For those who don’t like it and want something more basic, there is also a plain black colour option. One thing that seems out of order on the back panel, however, is the camera module. Here, the cameras are aligned vertically in a pill-shaped module. If you look closely, the placement of the two cameras and one flash aren’t symmetrical. The gap between the LED flash and bottom edge of the module is bigger than the gap between the edge and camera placed on top. This isn’t something you will notice initially, but once you notice, you can’t unsee it.

Up front, the best thing about the front display in terms of design is that the bezels are even on all four sides. Apart from this, we get a flat frame with the power button and volume rockers placed

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on the right side of the frame. The USB type-C port is placed at the bottom of the display, and there is a noise canceling mic along with the IR blaster on top of the frame.

DISPLAY

The OnePlus Nord CE 4 display is very vibrant and crisp. I watched quite a lot of content and played quite a few games on this display and I must say that it looks really good most of the time. Yes, during gaming the graphics don’t feel as detailed as compared to some of the flagships, but watching a movie or a YouTube video in HDR is quite immersive.

We also tested this display to quite an extent. First, the brightness since sunlight visibility is important for most users. The smartphone showcased an impressive luminance of 972 nits under bright sunlight, which is better than many flagships out there today so this is great.

In our colour check analysis, the smartphone showcased an average DeltaE or average error of 2.5, which is good for a smartphone, but not the best in this range. For reference, an average DeltaE of under

3 is considered great for smartphones, but with the technology getting better, there are smartphones that have showcased much better results.

I also ran a Greyscale test and found the smartphone to be blowing up the blues. This result is also replicated in the colour checker analysis, since the whites on this smartphone were one of the least accurate which appear a bit blue-ish. This is also not good since more blue light is said to have worse effects on a user’s eyes in the long run.

Overall, this is a decent display for watching videos and content. It is bright, it is crisp, and there is HDR support for watching content. Even for gaming it is decent, but given that there is too much blue light, doing any of those for a longer period of time may turn out to be harmful for users.

PERFORMANCE

Coming to performance, this is the OnePlus Nord CE 4’s home ground. During my day-to-day usage, the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G was pretty consistent in terms of the performance. During my time with the smartphone, there was no point in time that the OnePlus Nord CE 4 felt slow or laggy. Be it opening multiple apps at once, or switching between apps, or even gaming, the Nord CE 4 5G felt like a reliable companion throughout.

But of course, my experience doesn’t objectify the smartphone’s performance. I ran multiple synthetic benchmarks on the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G, and the smartphone showcased impressive numbers across CPU and GPU tests. For example, the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G came ahead of its fiercest competitor, the Nothing Phone (2a) in most benchmarks.

For example, on AnTuTu, the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G scored 821,575 points which is on the higher side when comparing all the mid-range smartphones available in the market and much ahead of the Nothing Phone (2a)’s score of 702,338 points. In Geekbench also, the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G comes ahead of the Nothing Phone (2a), but in the single-core test, the Nothing Phone (2a) comes one point ahead of the OnePlus Nord CE 4 5G.